Vittoria Iannotta

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Research Interests

I am a researcher working in macro-finance and banking. I study how banks and firms interact in the market for credit: what determines loan pricing, how credit is allocated across firms, and how monetary policy affects equilibrium outcomes.

Education

PhD candidate in Economics at **HEC Paris** 2023 - present

Advisor: Prof. Gaetano Gaballo

- Summer 2025, Summer Graduate Program in honor of Ivan Jaccard,
  Financial Research Division, **European Central Bank**
  References: Simone Manganelli, David Marqués-Ibáñez
- Fall 2024, Visiting Scholar, **University of Pennsylvania**, Department of Economics.
  Sponsor: Prof. Guillermo Ordonez
- Spring 2025, Visiting Scholar, **Banque de France**, Financial Economics Research Division.

M.S. in Management Sciences - **HEC Paris** 2021 - 2023

M.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - **Bocconi University**
Thesis Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Giavazzi 2017 - 2020

B.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - **Bocconi University** 2014 - 2017

Job Market Paper

Default risk surprises and banks' loan pricing.
Using one million loans matched to firms' public credit ratings, I show that interest rate differentials unexplained by observables at issuance contain information about future changes in firms' default probability. On average, firms whose default probability deteriorates by 1 p.p. one year after loan issuance were charged an otherwise unexplained 0.04 p.p. rate premium at issuance; the premium doubles for younger and smaller firms and strengthen in crises. Information that banks know at loan issuance arises as a potential driver of interest rate dispersion and of the positive relationship between rates and default risk. Yet, it is not necessary: the same pattern can emerge in a market with search frictions. I bring these forces together in a search model of loan pricing with asymmetric information in which banks see an imperfect public signal on firms' risk types. In equilibrium, the positive rate-risk relationship can arise either when the signal is sufficiently precise to separate borrowers, or, even when it is uninformative, from search frictions that lead banks to randomize between pooling borrowers and inducing self-selection through pricing. A calibration disentangles the forces at play in each credit rating class: in safer markets, banks are informed and separate borrowers; in riskier ones, they are uninformed and pool borrowers.

References

Prof. Gaetano Gaballo (Advisor)
Professor of Economics, HEC Paris
gaballo@hec.fr

Prof. Johan Hombert
Professor of Finance, HEC Paris
hombert@hec.fr

Prof. Benjamin Lester
Vice President and Economist,
Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia
Benjamin.Lester@phil.frb.org

Prof. Refet S. Gürkaynak
Professor of Economics, Bilkent University
refet@bilkent.edu.tr

Presentations

The **Wharton School, Finance** (Internal presentation), Fall 2024. **Paris Macro Workshop**, May 2025. **European Central Bank** (Internal Seminar), May 2025. Economics Letters Summer School in Macro-Finance at **Bocconi SDA**, July 2025. **ICBFS Conference**, Piacenza, Sep 2025. 4th PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, Naples School of Economics (NSE) of the **University of Naples Federico II**, Sep 2025. 9th Dauphine Finance PhD Workshop, **Université Paris Dauphine - PSL**, June 2026. **European Summer Symposium in Financial Markets** (Evening Sessions), Jul 2026. **Fourth Women in Central Banking Workshop**, Banco de Mexico, (scheduled Nov 6th).

Work Experience

Research Analyst, European Central Bank Apr 2020 - Jun 2021

Title: Traineeship (1 year) + Research Analyst (3 months). *Area:* Monetary Analysis.
Main Activities: Data collection (Orbis, ECB series), macroeconometric analysis of time series data (including monetary aggregates, bank lending volumes and interest rates), Microeconometric analysis of firm panel data (balance sheets, firm-bond links). *References:* Fédéric Holm-Hadulla

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Introduction to Macroeconomics. 2022, 2023

Program: MSc in Economics and Finance, HEC Paris. *Latest teaching evaluations*: 4.32/5 (2023/24).

Teaching assistant for Prof. Michau, Advanced Macroeconomics. 2023, 2024, 2025

Program: MSc in Economics, Ecole Polytechnique. *Latest teaching evaluations*: 4.22/5 (2024/25)

Teaching assistant for Prof Ai-Ting Goh, Macroeconomics. 2024, 2025

Program: MBA simulation games, HEC Paris.

Instructor for ESSEC IRENE France, Game Theory for Negotiation 2026

Program: One-day Professional Training, delivered at the Council of the European Union.

Skills

Datasets experience:
Credit registries: French Credit Registries, P2P lenders registry (ACPR, Banque de France)
Firm-level data: National balance sheet data (FIBEN, Bank of France), Orbis,Amadeus (BvD)
Financial analysis: Eikon, Datastream

Macroeconomic analysis: ECB series, BSI, MIR

Statistical Packages and Programming:

R, Stata, Matlab	(Advanced) data management, statistical and econometric analysis, visualisation
Python	(Advanced) structural estimation, model simulations, visualization, webscraping.
SQL	(Intermediate) data management
SPSS, Eviews	(Basic) data management, statistical and econometric analysis
Microsoft Office	PowerPoint, Word, Excel